

I have consolidated repeated questions, aligned wording, removed unnecessary overlaps, and grouped content into logical sections so it is easier for students to navigate and understand.

Internship FAQ for Students

This document answers common questions about internships for students enrolled in professional and Software Engineering degree programs.

1. Eligibility and Enrolment

Can I enrol in internship subjects if I haven't secured an internship yet?

- **Software Engineering students** who have completed their first two years may enrol in their remaining coursework while continuing to apply for an internship.
- If an internship is secured and approved at the start of semester, students may withdraw from coursework and enrol in the internship courses.
- **Students in professional degree programs** (Information Technology, Computer Science, Cybersecurity, Data Science) who have completed all coursework except the internship must contact the **Professional Year Coordinator Program Manager** for personalised advice before enrolling.

Do I need to complete all coursework before starting an internship?

Ideally, all coursework should be completed before commencing an internship.

However, internships secured earlier may be considered on a **case-by-case basis**.

- Students may undertake **no more than one additional course** during their internship.
- This requires approval from the **Professional Year Coordinator Program Manager and Internship Manager**.

2. Internship Duration and Structure

How long must the internship be?

- Internships must run for a **minimum of 40 weeks**.
- They must **span two standard teaching semesters**.
- Summer semesters **do not count** toward this requirement.

If the internship runs for a full calendar year, start dates are flexible as the two-semester requirement is automatically met.

Is there any flexibility if the internship is slightly shorter than 40 weeks?

In limited circumstances, internships slightly shorter than 40 weeks may be considered.

Students must discuss this **in advance** with the **Professional Year Coordinator Program Manager** and obtain approval.

Is this the same as a “summer internship”?

No. Unlike short-term internships (1–3 months), this is a **substantial, assessed, paid placement** that forms part of your academic program.

3. Workplace and Employment Conditions

Must the internship be with one employer?

It is strongly recommended that students remain with one employer for the full duration.

- If an employer change is unavoidable, students must work with the new employer for a **minimum of four months**.
- All changes require approval.

Does the internship need to be paid?

Yes. **All internships must be paid.**

- **Australia:** At least the **Australian minimum wage plus superannuation**.
- **Overseas:** Remuneration must align with the **local market rate** for a junior graduate role.

The Course Coordinator will advise the acceptable minimum salary for each country.

4. Overseas and Remote Internships

Can I complete my internship overseas?

Yes, provided you:

- Remain in the host country for the entire placement, **or**

- If working remotely while in Australia, the employer pays at least the **Australian minimum wage plus superannuation**.

Indicative salary benchmarks exist for countries such as India, Malaysia, China, and Indonesia. Students must discuss individual circumstances with the Course Coordinator **before proceeding**.

5. Finding and Approving an Internship

Does RMIT guarantee an internship?

No. Students are responsible for finding their own internship.

However, the University provides extensive support, including:

- Resume and cover letter workshops
- Interview preparation sessions
- Industry engagement activities
- Internship opportunities shared through a **Microsoft Teams channel**

What if I find my own internship externally?

If you self-source a **paid, degree-relevant role**:

- Contact your **Course Coordinator** for approval **before applying**, provided the role has not already been advertised via the Teams channel.

How do I register my internship with the University?

1. Submit your signed employment contract to your **Course Coordinator**.
2. Once approved, complete the required **WIL documentation**.
3. The University will arrange a third-party agreement between you, the employer, and RMIT.
4. After written approval, you may enrol in the internship courses.

6. Course Enrolment Requirements

Which subjects should I enrol in?

Software Engineering

- **Semester 1 start:**
INTE2710 + INTE2708 → followed by INTE2711 + INTE2709
- **Semester 2 start:**
Reverse the above order

Professional Programs (IT, CS, Data Science, Cybersecurity)

- **≈360 hours per semester or more:**
INTE2376 + INTE2374 → followed by INTE2377 + INTE2375
- **≈240 hours per semester:**
Follow the alternative pathway outlined in your **Program Guide**

Always refer to your Program Guide for the most current course information.

7. Assessment and Academic Requirements

Are there academic requirements during the internship?

Yes. Students remain enrolled at RMIT and must complete required assessments via Canvas, including:

- Monthly progress reports
- End-of-semester final presentation

Employer feedback also contributes to the overall course grade.

8. Credit for Prior or Current Employment

Can I receive internship credit for previous or current work?

Yes, via a formal credit application process. You must provide:

- Employment contract and payslips

- Official position description
- Manager's performance statement
- Evidence of **40 weeks of full-time work** (excluding leave)
- A statement mapping your duties to internship learning outcomes

Applications are submitted through **RMIT Connect** and assessed by a committee once per semester.

9. Fees

Do I pay course fees during the internship?

- **Students commencing in 2026 or later:** Pay full course fees.
- **Students commencing before 2026:** Pay fees only for **12 credit points** (Reflection course).

Course names and structures may change—always check your Program Guide.

10. If You Don't Secure an Internship in Time

What are my options?

- **Domestic students:** May apply for a **one-semester leave of absence**, then re-enrol once an internship is secured.
- **International students:** Leave of absence may not be permitted due to visa conditions. In most cases, students may need to:
 - Transfer to a three-year degree and graduate, or
 - Seek tailored advice from **RMIT Connect**

When should I start applying?

Begin planning and applying **at least one semester in advance**.